

Guidelines for the production of your EEN1095 project portfolio (for submissions in 2026)

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Important Note on Originality, GenAI, Citing Others and Plagiarism

You will be required to submit an electronic copy of your portfolio via Loop. This will automatically upload the report to a text-similarity analysis tool, and your supervisor will check the similarity report and your submitted report for any evidence of text or other content reproduced from other sources without proper citation.

Before preparing your portfolio, carefully read the document “Understanding and Avoiding Plagiarism”, which can be found on the project Loop page. Failure to comply with the requirements for originality in your work will be regarded as a major breach of discipline.

If you are in any doubt as to whether your submission complies with the requirements on originality and attribution, consult your supervisor or the project coordinator prior to submitting the project portfolio.

Any use of GenAI must be clearly stated in an Appendix. The form of GenAI used and its purpose must be described. The associated sections in the portfolio must be clearly identified.

1 Introduction

The centrepiece of your portfolio submission is a conference-style research paper. This should largely mimic the appearance of an IEEE transactions paper with a two-column format. See the IEEE guidelines at <https://journals.ieeeauthorcenter.ieee.org/create-your-ieee-journal-article/authoring-tools-and-templates/tools-for-ieee-authors/ieee-article-templates/>. Select a transactions template.

2 Paper Format

It is **ABSOLUTELY ESSENTIAL** that your document uses A4 paper size.

Use “EEN1095 Project Portfolio” as the “Journal” title for your paper. Omit the “vol. X, no. Y” in the header as it is not appropriate but record the date of publication in the header as “August 2026”.

See, for example, <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/Xplore/home.jsp> for examples of what real IEEE papers look like. Your paper is limited to **SIX** pages in length. This is a typical page limit for conferences, and means you must be selective and concise in what you record in the paper. Your supervisor may offer some advice on what content to include.

3 Sections and Content

Read a few research papers to get an idea of the style of language used, the typical names of the section headings, and the comparative size of each section. Where there is a choice of style in technical reports, follow the IEEE style (e.g., use IEEE referencing). The following text describes the **specific** reporting requirements for your final project report. You can only depart from these, should the nature of your project require it, if you have **written** agreement from your supervisor to a modified paper layout.

The constituent elements of your paper should be as follows. Note that the names of the section headings here (with the exception of the abstract and introduction) should be changed, if appropriate, to reflect the specifics of your project and your paper.

Abstract

This is a short, one-paragraph, description of the achievement. It might contain one sentence describing the problem and its importance, one sentence describing previous approaches and their deficiencies, one sentence describing the key principle behind the reported research, another describing the results obtained and a final sentence describing the value of what was achieved.

For example:

The design of a practical time machine has obvious applications in stock market speculation and dinosaur hunting. Previous attempts at such a design by Wells and his research team, and by the Tardis project, suffered from limited payload capacity and an unstable control algorithm respectively. I describe a new approach to time travel using quantum wormhole enlargement. Laboratory experiments have confirmed that this technique supports forward travel in time at rates of 1 ss^{-1} for objects of arbitrary mass. The theoretical principles underlying this approach should permit practical extension to a wider range of rates, allowing the entire cosmos to be conveyed through time.

Your abstract should be no longer than **150 words**. Although it is the first part of your paper others will read, it should be the last thing you write. How can you summarise a paper if it is not written yet?

Introduction

This contains perhaps one paragraph describing the context of the problem under investigation, one describing the significance of the problem, one describing prior work and its merits and deficiencies, one describing your approach and the results obtained and another stating the value of the work. Expanding each of the sentences in your abstract into a paragraph will give you a good first draft of your introduction.

A common fault in paper introductions (even in published papers) is to write sentences like “Section II describes the state of the art...Finally, Section V presents the conclusions and ideas for further research”. This is wrong on two fronts. Each section is inanimate and cannot perform actions (so rephrase as “I describe, in Section II,...”). Also, your readers know the conventional structure of papers — telling them that you will conclude with conclusions is wasting ink (or electrons). It is usually appropriate to refer forward to later sections of the paper in the introduction, but do so in an “embedded” way, e.g., “The mechanism used to achieve this is quantum wormhole expansion, using the quantum foam capture methods described in Section II of the paper”.

Prior Work

This is a survey of the state of the art. It should be more than a list of citations of prior work. Give this section a title relevant to your project (“Existing techniques for chronological displacement”). Organise prior work in groups and evaluate them. What are their common features, strengths and weaknesses? This section should persuade the reader that there is a gap in the research literature, and hint that the technique you are about to describe will help to fill that gap.

The prior art on which you base this section should be selected and discussed with care. Only the references that are genuinely relevant to your project should be emphasised, and the portfolio should normally identify no more than **5 key references** for detailed assessment purposes. These key references should be the principal sources on which your design, implementation, analysis and comparison are based.

The combined length of the paper up to the end of this section should not exceed *ONE PAGE*.

Technical Description

Rename this section as appropriate.

Here you describe the technical approach you have taken in your project. This might include descriptions of algorithms, hardware designs, software architecture, methodologies, mathematical techniques, simulation models, or other facets of your design. Strive for clarity. Write a first draft of this section, print it out, and read it. Read it carefully. Does it make sense? No, it does not. Try to figure out what its flaws are. Now delete it and start over. Continually revising a poorly structured first draft of a description of your Great Idea will get you nowhere. Figure out what the structure should have been and write a second draft complying with that structure.

Use consistent notation and terminology. If it was x_i in the second paragraph, don't let it mutate into X by the end of the section. You can ensure this by deciding on notation and terminology before writing a word of this section.

Make sure to present ideas in a logical order. Don't make the reader read ahead in the paper to find out what a quantum displacer is — if you are using one in this paragraph, it should have been explained to the reader by now.

This section should be **TWO PAGES** in length.

Results Obtained

Rename this section as appropriate.

Document your results here. Use tables and scatter plots, histograms, etc. to present numerical results. Make sure that the scenario used to obtain each set of results is described unambiguously. There should be sufficient information in this section and the previous one for the interested reader to replicate your results.

Put some thought into how you visualise your results. If you generated lots of data, should it be presented in a 3D plot? On multiple 2D plots? What scales should you use? Log? Linear? If you use colour in your plots, will the traces still be distinguishable if printed in monochrome?

Describe how you know your results are valid. What testing strategies were used? Were enough results obtained? Does your algorithm perform correctly? Does your code implement your algorithm accurately? Does your input data set contain features of the kind the algorithm is supposed to extract?

This section should be **ONE PAGE** in length.

Analysis

Rename this section as appropriate.

Interpret your results here. You've obtained lots of data. What have you learned from it? Does accepting transit traffic overload the router? What do the peaks in the spectral response indicate? Why are there no fluctuations in the EEG data?

This section should be **ONE PAGE** in length.

The division of the body of the report into three sections (here named "Technical Description", "Results Obtained" and "Analysis") may be inappropriate for some projects. If you wish to change this structure, you may do so **only** in consultation with your supervisor and **only** with his/her written agreement to the revised structure — any such revised paper format must have an aggregate length of four pages for the sections equivalent to the above three.

Conclusions

Here you summarise what has been achieved and learned, and the implications for future research and suggestions for future work that could follow on from your work. This section resembles the introduction in some ways, but remember that by now the reader has read the body of the paper. The introduction was your attempt to encourage them to do so. You can present insights in the conclusions. Clearly describe what work you did and what your contributions are.

References

Make sure to cite all appropriate papers, books, URLs, etc. and include them in your list of references. Do not list a publication here if it is not referred to earlier in the paper. For assessment purposes, the portfolio should normally identify no more than **5 key references** to be examined in detail by assessors. Please refer to Appendix C.5 for detailed instructions.

Appendices (*if any*)

Most research papers contain no appendices. You might put a lengthy mathematical proof, or a description of a simulation schematic, in an appendix, if describing it in the body of the paper would interrupt the flow of text.

The combined length of the Conclusions, References and Appendices of the paper should not exceed ONE PAGE , so that the overall paper is SIX PAGES long.
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4 Portfolio Documents

In addition to the centrepiece research paper, your portfolio will include several additional documents (appendices).

The first of these additional documents will be a statement on the use of GenAI. The second appendix will be the status report that you submitted in EEN1101. The third appendix will be the original approved project plan in EEN1101 together with a concise record of implementation progress, key milestones, major changes to scope or methodology, reasons for those changes, and a clear account of the final achievements against plan. The remaining appendices are project-specific, but might include design and implementation details, supplementary testing and results, or repository-based technical material required to support detailed assessment. Any documentation which will not fit into the research paper, but which you feel should be read by the examiners, should be included here in a structured and curated form.

Each portfolio document should be presented as an Appendix to the overall document and each one should be preceded by a title page, blank other than text such as the following (in 24 point bold):

Appendix A

Use of GenAI

Appendix content follows...

(This shadowed box is supposed to represent a page of your document.)

You may cite these documents in the main paper as in the following example.

...A more extensive summary of implementation details may be found in Appendix D...

.....

[4] A. Student, “Project Design and Implementation”, EEN1095 Final Portfolio, Appendix D, August 2026.

An example set of documents for your portfolio might be:

- Conference-style Paper (*compulsory*)
- Appendix A — Use of GenAI (*compulsory*)
 - State which tool was used.
 - State which sections of the portfolio and appendices involved its use.
 - State why it was used and comment on its benefits.
 - If no GenAI tools were used in preparing the portfolio, students should explicitly state this in Appendix A, for example: “No GenAI tools were used in preparing this portfolio.”
- Appendix B — Status Report (*compulsory*)
 - You should include the previously submitted status report in EEN1101.
- Appendix C — Project Plan, Progress, and Achievements (*compulsory*)

- You should include the original approved project plan in EEN1101 together with a concise record of implementation progress, key milestones, major changes to scope or methodology, reasons for those changes, and a clear account of the final achievements against plan.
- This appendix should also identify the **key references for detailed assessment** (normally no more than **5 references**). For each key reference, students should give a concise account of what the work is about, why it is relevant to the project, its strength or limitation in the context of the project, and how the proposed solution relates to and differs from it.
- These key references should also be cited appropriately in the six-page conference paper.
- Appendix D — Design and Implementation Details (*recommended*)
 - This appendix may include architecture, methodology details, algorithms, schematics, derivations, implementation decisions, or other technical material that is too detailed for the main paper.
- Appendix E — Testing and Supplementary Results (*highly recommended*)
 - This appendix may include extended testing methodology, additional experiments, validation details, tables, figures, comparisons, and supplementary results not included in the main paper.
- Appendix F — Project Repository (*compulsory*)
 - The project repository includes the key materials needed to support the claims made in the portfolio, such as coding files, implementation files, design documentation, test or measurement setup details, results summaries, and demonstration material, as appropriate to the nature of the project.
 - The repository material should be uploaded to **Loop**, normally as a `.zip` file, as part of the formal submission. Students should not rely solely on external cloud links, as access permissions may change or prevent assessors from reviewing the material. The required repository evidence must be formally submitted through Loop.
 - This appendix should include a short index or readme describing the most important files or core items and clearly distinguishing any supplementary material.
 - The identified core items for detailed review should normally not exceed **10 items**. However, it is important to note that assessors are not limited to these items and may inspect other material in the submitted repository where necessary to verify claims made in the portfolio, understand the context of the work, or assess the completeness of the evidence provided.
 - Students are responsible for ensuring that the submitted repository material is complete and accessible. Material that is missing, inaccessible, or not properly submitted may not be considered for assessment.

Illustrative Example of Appendix C

The following example shows one possible way to present Appendix C. Students may adapt this structure as appropriate to the nature of their project, but should ensure that the original plan, implementation progress, major changes, achievements against plan, and the key references for detailed assessment are clearly presented.

Appendix C — Project Plan, Progress, and Achievements

C.1 Original Approved Plan

Briefly reproduce or summarise the original approved project plan from EEN1101, including the main objectives, proposed methodology, and intended outputs.

C.2 Progress and Key Milestones

Provide a concise summary of implementation progress across the summer period, for example using a short timeline or milestone table.

C.3 Major Changes to Scope or Methodology

Explain any major changes made to the original plan, why they were made, and how they affected the project.

C.4 Achievements Against Plan

Use a short table to map the original objectives to the final achievements and indicate where supporting evidence may be found in the portfolio.

C.5 Key References for Detailed Assessment

The following table gives one possible format.

Ref. in paper	Full citation	Concise explanation
[a]	[insert details]	What the paper is about; why it is relevant; its strength or limitation in the context of this project; and how the proposed solution relates to and differs from it.
[b]	[insert details]	What the paper is about; why it is relevant; its strength or limitation in the context of this project; and how the proposed solution relates to and differs from it.
[c]	[insert details]	What the paper is about; why it is relevant; its strength or limitation in the context of this project; and how the proposed solution relates to and differs from it.

Note: The key references identified here must also be cited appropriately in the six-page conference paper, and students should be prepared to discuss them in the interview. The reference numbering presented in the table above should be consistent with the reference order used in the paper.

Illustrative Example of Appendix F

The following example shows one possible way to present Appendix F. Students may adapt the structure depending on the nature of their project. The project repository submitted on Loop should contain the main implementation files, results, demonstration material, and supporting documentation relevant to the final assessment. It should include a README file explaining the repository structure, the selected core items, and any instructions needed to run, inspect, or interpret the materials. Students should identify up to 10 core items for detailed review. A core item may be a single file, folder, notebook, video, archive, or clearly indexed set of related files.

Appendix F — Project Repository

Loop submission: `studentID_project_repository.zip`

Core items for detailed review:

1. `README.pdf` — overview of repository structure, selected core items, and instructions for use.
2. `src/main_model.py` — core implementation of the proposed method.
3. `results/final_results.csv` — final quantitative results reported in the portfolio.
4. `testing/baseline_scenarios/` — structured testing output folder, including baseline test cases, validation outputs, summary metrics, key figures, and logs.
5. `demo/demo_video.mp4` — final demonstration of the working system.
6. `docs/system_architecture.pdf` — supporting implementation and design details.
- 7–10. ... — further clearly identified core items, if required.

Supplementary material: Any additional folders, intermediate files, archived prototypes, raw logs, exploratory results, unused code, extra plots, or background materials should be clearly labelled as supplementary unless explicitly identified above for detailed review.

This list is purely indicative. The selected core items and the distinction between core and supplementary material must be clear. The purpose is not to require assessors to review every file in the repository, but to highlight the main evidence that should be considered when assessing the substantive project work.

5 Putting it All Together

The portfolio should have a cover page with the main title being the title of your project, and the subtitle being “project portfolio”, e.g.,

Frequency Domain Analysis of Extraterrestrial Equipment

Project Portfolio

This will be followed by an Acknowledgements page. A contents page will follow. It should list the main paper and sections, and the titles and sections of any appendices, with the appropriate page numbers.

This is followed by the main paper and the additional support documents as appendices, interleaved with title pages, as noted above.

6 Pagination

Pages in the main paper will be numbered 1,2,3,4,5,6. The appendices will be numbered A.1, A.2,... B.1, B.2,... as appropriate.